בס״ד

The `shiur` package

Source sheets (*dappei mekorot*) for handouts and slides

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Introduction

`shiur` typesets Jewish source sheets: numbered sources, each in Hebrew with an English translation, with notes for the person giving the class (the *maggid shiur*). From one file of content it can produce:

- a handout for participants (*talmid*), and one with the teacher's notes (*maggid shiur*);
- a bilingual handout and a Hebrew-only one;
- a large-print handout;
- beamer slides, with long sources split over several slides.

Each version is a two- or three-line wrapper file around the shared content, so a correction made once appears in every version.

The package needs XeLaTeX and a font with Hebrew. It loads `polyglossia` (with English as the main language and Hebrew as the other), `geometry`, `fancyhdr`, `framed`, `xcolor` and `hyperref`, among others.

A first source sheet

```
\documentclass[11pt]{article}
\usepackage{shiur}
\setshiurfont{hebrew}{FreeSerif}

\title{Wheat from the clouds}
\author{A. Teacher}
\date{}

\begin{document}
\makeTitle

\begin{mekor}
```

```
\begin{mekorlang}{hebrew}{בבלי מנחות ס"ט ע"ב}
בעי ר' זירא: חיטין שירדו בעבים מהו?
\end{mekorlang}
\begin{mekorlang}{english}{B. Mena\hdot ot 69b}
R. Zeira asked: ``if wheat descended in clouds, what is the law?''
\end{mekorlang}
\end{mekor}

\end{document}
```

`\setshiurfont{hebrew}{...}` chooses the Hebrew font, for handouts and slides alike. Without it, the package picks an installed font itself (see "Fonts"). `\makeTitle` prints the title and starts the page style, with בס״ד at the top right of each page.

The source above comes out like this:

א. בבלי מנחות ס״ט ע״ב

בעי ר׳ זירא: חיטין שירדו בעבים מהו?

1. B. Menaḥot 69b

R. Zeira asked: "if wheat descended in clouds, what is the law?"

Sources

`mekor` and `mekor*`

A `mekor` holds one source and gives it the next number. A `mekor*` holds a source that continues the previous one, and takes no new number. On slides, each `mekor` is a frame.

`mekorlang`

```
\begin{mekorlang}[subtitle]{language}{title}
  text
\end{mekorlang}
```

Each language of a source is a `mekorlang`. Hebrew is set right to left with Hebrew numerals, and any other language left to right with arabic numerals. Hebrew has three names, which differ only in font (see "Fonts"): `hebrew` for most text, `mikra` for Tanakh, and `rashi` for text in Rashi script. The number of the source goes in the margin of a handout. The optional subtitle, in italics under the title, usually names the author or the translation:

```
\begin{mekorlang}[\attribution{R. Asher Weiss}{Jerusalem}{5780}]
```

```
  {english}{Min\hdot at Asher}
```

\attribution{who}{where}{when} joins its non-empty parts with commas, giving "R. Asher Weiss, Jerusalem, 5780".

Notes

Notes are the maggid shiur's commentary: questions to ask, points to make, transitions. They are printed only in the **maggidshiur** version, beside a grey bar on the side where their lines start.

```
\begin{note}
Why does R. Zeira ask about wheat rather than any other food?
\end{note}

\begin{note}[hebrew]
הערה בעברית.
\end{note}
```

> Why does R. Zeira ask about wheat rather than any other food?

> הערה בעברית.

The optional argument is the language of the note, English by default; **hebrew**, **mikra** and **rashi** all give a Hebrew note. There are four note environments, which all look the same:

note a note anywhere;

gnote the same, for documents that load beamer or **beamerarticle**, which define their own **\note**;

prenote a note introducing a source;

postnote a note following a source.

The difference between the last two matters only on slides: when a source is split over several slides (see "Splitting a long source over several slides"), its **prenote** goes on the first slide and its **postnote** on the last.

Options

Option	Effect
`talmid`	Leave out the notes. This is the default.
`maggidshiur`	Print the notes.
`translations=false`	Leave out each English `mekorlang` that follows a Hebrew one in the same source. Sources written in English, with no Hebrew before them, stay.
`accessible`	Set the handout in large print: 18 pt type, with every other size scaled to match, and unjustified text (ragged right for English, ragged left for Hebrew). Slides are unchanged.
`accessible=`*size*	The same, at another size, e.g. `accessible=20pt`.

When one version needs text that another doesn't, `\iftranslations{A}{B}` typesets *A* in the bilingual version and *B* in the Hebrew-only one:

```
\iftranslations{\begin{note}A note about the translation.\end{note}}{}
```

One body, several versions

Put everything from `\begin{document}` to `\end{document}` in a body file, and give each version a small file of its own. If the versions differ only in options, the body can hold the whole document, preamble included, and each version passes its options before reading it:

```
% shiur_hebrew.tex
\PassOptionsToPackage{translations=false}{shiur}
\input{shiur_body}
```

```
% shiur_notes.tex
\PassOptionsToPackage{maggidshiur}{shiur}
\input{shiur_body}
```

Handouts and slides from one body

A handout and a beamer presentation need different document classes, so each keeps its own preamble and reads the body with `\input`. The handout loads `beamerarticle` before `shiur`, so the body can use beamer's commands in both:

```
% shiur.tex: the handout
\documentclass[11pt]{article}
\usepackage{beamerarticle}
```

```
\usepackage[talmid]{shiur}
\setshiurfont{hebrew}{FreeSerif}
\title{Wheat from the clouds}
\author{A. Teacher}
\date{}
\input{shiur_body}
```

```
% shiur_slides.tex: the presentation
\documentclass{beamer}
\usepackage{shiur}
\setshiurfont{hebrew}{FreeSerif}
\title{Wheat from the clouds}
\author{A. Teacher}
\date{}
\input{shiur_body}
```

In the body:

- use `gnote` rather than `note`, since beamer has its own `\note`;
- `\mode<presentation>{...}` holds material for the slides only, such as a frame of photographs, and `\mode<article>{...}` material for the handout only;
- `\makeTitle` makes a title page on the handout and a title frame on the slides.

Splitting a long source over several slides

A source too long for one slide can be split with `\mekorbreak`, placed at the same point in each language. The handout ignores it and prints the source whole. On the slides, the source stays one frame, with one slide for each part. Every slide repeats the headings, and an ellipsis marks each side of a cut, replacing any punctuation there:

```
\begin{mekor}
\begin{mekorlang}{hebrew}{קיד תהלים}
כָּל־הָאֻמִּים׃ שַׁבְּחוּהוּ כָּל־הָעֻמִּים אֶת־יְהוָה הַלְלוּ
\mekorbreak
יְהוָה׃ לְעוֹלָם וָאֶמֶת יְהוָה חֶסֶד וְעַל־נוּ גָּבַר כִּי
\end{mekorlang}
\begin{mekorlang}{english}{Psalm 117}
Praise the Lord, all you nations; extol Him, all you peoples.
\mekorbreak
For great is His steadfast love toward us...
\end{mekorlang}
\end{mekor}
```

`\mekorbreak*` splits without the ellipses, where nothing is cut, for example where a question ends and its answer begins.

Fonts

Hebrew text has three roles, each with its own font:

`hebrew` rabbinic and other text, and every role's fallback;

`mikra` Tanakh. Its *trop* (cantillation marks) sits beside and among the vowels, and only some fonts position it well;

`rashi` text in Rashi script, such as a commentary printed in it.

Choose a role's font in the preamble, with any of `fontspec`'s options before or after the name:

```
\setshiurfont{hebrew}{Frank Ruehl CLM}
\setshiurfont{mikra}{Taamey Frank CLM}
\setshiurfont{rashi}{Noto Rashi Hebrew}
\setshiurfont{mikra}{TaameyFrankCLM}[Path=fonts/, Extension=.ttf,
  UprightFont=*-Medium, BoldFont=*-Bold]
```

A role you don't set gets the first of these fonts that is installed, and the log says which:

Role	Fonts tried, in order
`hebrew`	Taamey Frank CLM, Ezra SIL, Keter YG, Noto Serif Hebrew, FreeSerif
`mikra`	Taamey Frank CLM, Taamey David CLM, Ezra SIL, SBL Hebrew, Keter YG
`rashi`	Noto Rashi Hebrew

If none of a role's fonts is installed, `mikra` and `rashi` use the `hebrew` font, and `hebrew` ends with FreeSerif, which comes with TEX Live. Documents that set `\hebrewfont` (or `\hebrewfontsf` in beamer) with `\newfontfamily` keep that font as the `hebrew` one. A `mikra` or `rashi` font that lacks some punctuation, as Rashi fonts often do, borrows it from the `hebrew` font.

The sample sheet `shiur-fonts.pdf`, next to this manual, shows all three roles in use.

Fonts for trop

A general Hebrew font may have every trop mark and still place them badly, crowding a mark against a vowel or setting it off its letter. Figure 1 shows the same verses in FreeSerif and in Taamey Frank CLM, a font made for trop.

בְּרֵאשִׁית בָּרָא אֱלֹהִים אֵת הַשָּׁמַיִם וְאֵת הָאָרֶץ׃ וְהָאָרֶץ הָיְתָה תֹהוּ וָבֹהוּ FreeSerif

בְּרֵאשִׁית בָּרָא אֱלֹהִים אֵת הַשָּׁמַיִם וְאֵת הָאָרֶץ׃ וְהָאָרֶץ הָיְתָה תֹהוּ וָבֹהוּ Taamey Frank CLM

Figure 1: Genesis 1:1–2 in a general font and in a font made for trop.

So that nobody's source sheet is let down by its fonts without their knowing, the package warns when a `mikra` source with trop is set in a font that isn't known to handle it, unless you chose

that font yourself with `\setshiurfont`. The warning appears once per document, among LaTeX's warnings, and says what to install. These fonts handle trop well, and are free:

Ezra SIL from SIL International (`https://software.sil.org/ezra/`); on Debian and Ubuntu, `sudo apt install fonts-sil-ezra`.

Taamey Frank CLM and Taamey David CLM, from the Culmus project (`https://culmus.sourceforge.io`).

Keter YG also from Culmus; on Debian and Ubuntu, `sudo apt install fonts-culmus`.

SBL Hebrew from the Society of Biblical Literature, free for non-commercial use.

For Rashi script, Noto Rashi Hebrew is part of Google's free Noto fonts.

Other commands

`\hdot`, `\Hdot` ḥ and Ḥ, for transliteration (Ḥanukah).

`\sectionsymbol` §.

`boxed` a paragraph in a box, on handouts only.

The package used to come with a separate `shiurbeamer` package for slides. `shiur` now detects the beamer class itself; `shiurbeamer` still works, and simply loads `shiur`.

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